

NARROW-MOUTHED FROGS

Frogs of the large and diverse family Microhylidae are found in the Americas, Asia, Australia, and Africa. Most are ground-dwelling and some live in burrows. Most have a short snout, a plump, often teardrop-shaped, body, and stout hind legs.



8–12 cm
3¼–4¾ in

TOMATO FROG
Dyscophus antongilii

Native to Madagascar, this frog stays buried in soil by day, emerging to feed at night. A sticky skin secretion protects it against predators.



5–7.5 cm
2–3 in

PAINTED TOAD
Kaloula pulchra

Widespread in Asia, this species has adapted well to human settlements. It protects itself with a noxious, sticky skin secretion.



3–6 cm
1¼–2¼ in

BLACK-SPOTTED NARROW-MOUTHED FROG
Kalophrynus pleurostigma

This frog from the Philippines protects itself by producing a sticky secretion. It breeds in small pools after rain.



2–3.5 cm
¾–1½ in

EASTERN NARROW-MOUTHED TOAD
Gastrophryne carolinensis

Found in the S.E. USA, this burrowing toad breeds in water bodies of all sizes. The male's call sounds like a bleating lamb.



2–2.5 cm
¾–1 in

GIANT STUMP-TOED FROG
Stumpffia grandis

This small terrestrial frog is found in leaf litter in high-altitude forests in Madagascar.

MEGOPHRYIDAE

Found across Asia, this is a small family of frogs whose body shape and colour patterns enable them to be camouflaged among leaves. They walk rather than jump, and most are ground-living.



horn-like projections on eyelids

cryptic coloration with black markings

ASIAN HORNED FROG
Pelobatrachus nasuta

This frog conceals itself among dead leaves, while it waits for prey. Females lay their eggs under rocks and logs in streams.

7–14 cm
2¾–5½ in

PARSLEY FROGS

Made up of only four species, the family Pelodytidae is confined to Europe and the Caucasus. Named for the green markings on their skin, parsley frogs breed after rain, laying their eggs in broad strips.



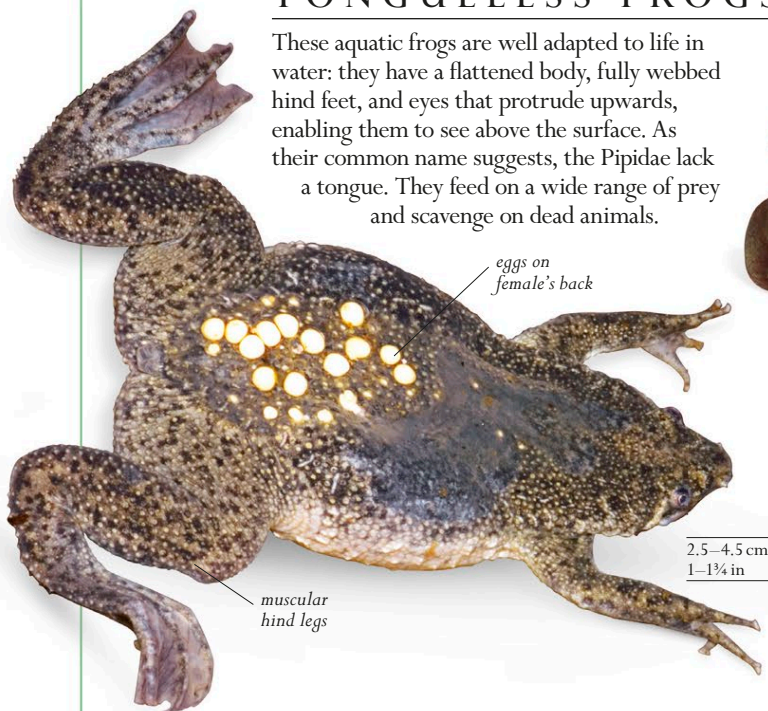
3–5 cm
1¼–2 in

COMMON PARSLEY FROG
Pelodytes punctatus

When climbing smooth, vertical surfaces, this European frog uses its underside as a sucker. Both sexes call during breeding.

TONGUELESS FROGS

These aquatic frogs are well adapted to life in water: they have a flattened body, fully webbed hind feet, and eyes that protrude upwards, enabling them to see above the surface. As their common name suggests, the Pipidae lack a tongue. They feed on a wide range of prey and scavenge on dead animals.



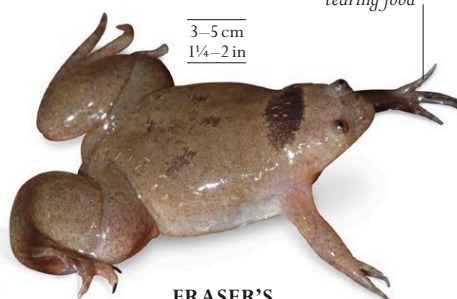
eggs on female's back

muscular hind legs

2.5–4.5 cm
1–1¾ in

DWARF SURINAM TOAD
Pipa parva

In this wholly aquatic species found in Venezuela and Colombia, the eggs develop on the female's back.



3–5 cm
1¼–2 in

claws used for tearing food

FRASER'S CLAWED FROG
Xenopus fraseri

Found in W. and C. Africa, this wholly aquatic frog thrives in human-altered habitats and is harvested by people for food.

SPADEFOOT TOADS

A small family found in Eurasia and North Africa, the Pelobatidae are characterized by horny projections on their hind feet. They use them to burrow into the ground, where they wait for rain.



4–8 cm
1½–3¼ in

COMMON SPADEFOOT TOAD
Pelobates fuscus

Found in Europe and Asia, this species is variable in colour. It has a plump body, which it inflates when attacked.